

Cult Mormon Polytheism

cult-mormon-polytheism

Cult Marker · Mormonism · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

There is one and only one true God, eternally and unchangeably; humans do not become gods, and the Son of God is not one among multiple divine beings. Jesus Christ is the eternal, uncreated Son of one substance with the Father, not a created spiritual being elder-brother to Satan or to humanity.

In plain language

Across both testaments the words used for God form a tight pattern of strict oneness. In Deuteronomy 6:4 the number one (echad) is predicated of the LORD our God, and Deuteronomy 4:35 says there is no other besides him. In Isaiah the LORD says no god was formed before me and none will be after me (43:10), there is no god besides me (44:6,8), there is none else and none besides me (45:5), no god other than me (45:21), and none like me (46:9), stacking the Hebrew exclusion particles biladey, zulah, eyn, od, and efes that close the divine class to exactly one. Hosea 13:4 repeats the same particle stack outside Isaiah, and Hosea 11:9 draws a categorical line between God and man (I am God and not man), which directly forecloses any trajectory of a creature becoming God. The Greek picks this up in 1 Timothy 2:5 with one God and one mediator the man Christ Jesus, and James 2:19 cites the Shema as one God outright. On the Son, John 1:1-3 places the Word with God and as God and then says all things came into being through him and not one thing came to be apart from him. The verb for coming to be is applied to created things and pointedly not to the Word, so he is uncreated. Colossians 1:16-17 says all things, including thrones, dominions, rulers, and authorities, were created in him, through him, and for him, that he is before all things, and that in him all things hold together. Hebrews 1 asks which of the angels was ever called Son, commands that all God's angels worship the firstborn, and has the Father address the Son as God with an eternal throne. Together these texts place the Son on the Creator side of the line, worshipped by angels rather than ranked among them. The lexical data therefore supports the proposition that there is one and only one true God, that no being becomes God, and that the Son is uncreated rather than a created spiritual elder brother to angels or humanity. Possible counter readings from Psalm 82 and John 10:34 use the word gods figuratively for human judges (who die like men in the next verse) and do not establish additional gods.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
H0259	אֶחָד	echad	one	944
H0369	אֵין	ayin	nothing	720
H0376	אִישׁ	ish	man	2,160
H0410	אֵל	el	God	245
H0430	אֱלֹהִים	elohim	God	2,606
H0589	אֲנִי	ani	I	
H0657	אֶפֶס	ephes	end	

H1107	בְּלַעַדִּי	biladey	beside	16
H2108	זִלְהָ	zulah	exception	13
H2416	חַי	chay	alive	
H3068	יְהוָה	YHWH	LORD	6,828
H3335	יָצַר	yatsar	to form	63
H3808	לֹא	lo	not	4,825
H5750	עוֹד	od	still	490
H6697	צוּר	tsur	Rocks (of Goats)	
H7223	רִשׁוֹן	rishon	first	
G0032	ἄγγελος	angelos	angel	
G0165	αἰών	aiōn	an age	
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	
G0846	αὐτός	autos	it/s/he	
G1080	γεννάω	gennao	to beget	97
G1096	γίνομαι	ginomai	to be	669
G1223	διά	dia	through/because of	
G1520	εἷς	heis	one	355
G1722	ἐν	en	in/on/among	
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,317
G2362	θρόνος	thronos	throne	62
G2936	κτίζω	ktizo	to create	15
G2962	κύριος	kurios	lord	
G3056	λόγος	logos	word	330
G3316	μεσίτης	mesites	mediator	6
G3956	πᾶς	pas	all	
G4160	ποιέω	poieō	to do/make	
G4253	πρό	pro	before	
G4314	πρός	pros	to/with	
G4416	πρωτότοκος	prōtotokos	firstborn	
G5207	υἱός	huios	son	377

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Four converging Hebrew exclusivity formulas stack across Deutero-Isaiah, with biladey (H1107, 16 canon occurrences concentrated in Isa 43-45) and zulah (H2108, 13 occurrences concentrated in Isa 45 and Hos 13:4) functioning as dedicated no-other-god particles, paired with the existential negator eyn (H0369) and the residue-negator od (H5750) over elohim (H0430) and el (H0410): Isa 43:10 lo notsar el, Isa 44:6,8 eyn elohim, Isa 45:5,21-22 eyn od, Isa 46:9 eyn od elohim, and Hos 13:4 elohim zulati lo teda all close the divine class to YHWH

alone in both temporal directions. Hos 11:9 (el anokhi velo ish, I am God and not man) sets the creature-Creator line as a categorical foreclosure of the as-God-is-man-may-become trajectory. The Greek picks up the same pattern with heis (G1520) governing theos in 1Tim 2:5 and Jas 2:19 (heis estin ho theos), while John 1:1-3 places the Logos pros ton theon with predicate theos and panta di autou egeneto (G1096) marking him as the agent and not a product of becoming, Col 1:16-17 puts every spiritual rank (thronoi, kyriotetes, archai, exousiai) on the created side of his ktizo (G2936), and Heb 1:5-8 has the Father address the Son as ho theos and command angelic proskuneo. The pattern is pan-canonical and unaffected by the (none-in-scope) ECM apparatus.

Scripture

Deut.6.4 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H3068 יהוה, H0430 אלהים, H0259 אחד.

Force. The Shema predicates the numeral echad of YHWH our God in a verbless clause (ETCBC marks the closing element PreC, predicate complement). Whether rendered the LORD is one or the LORD alone, the construction asserts singular exclusivity of Israel's God, leaving no room for a plurality of true gods.

Deut.4.35 · for · genre: law

Key terms. H3068 יהוה, H0430 אלהים, H5750 עוד

Force. YHWH hu ha-elohim, eyn od milvado (the LORD, he is God, there is no other besides him) supplies the foundation formula that Isa 43-46 will recycle. The bare od (still, more, besides) under the existential negator eyn closes the divine class with no remainder.

Isa.43.10 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3808 לא, H3335 יצר, H0410 אל, H0589 אני.

Force. The clause lo notsar el, with the niphal of yatsar (was formed) negated by lo, denies that any god was ever formed before YHWH, and the following acharay (after me) extends the denial forward. A god that comes into being, the premise of any exaltation-to-godhood scheme, is exactly what this verse forecloses in both temporal directions.

Isa.44.6 · for · genre: prophecy · figures: merism

Key terms. H0369 אין, H0430 אלהים, H1107 בלעדי, H7223 ראשון.

Force. YHWH titles himself rishon (first) and acharon (last) and declares umibaladay eyn elohim, besides me there is no god, pairing the exclusion preposition biladey with the existential negator eyn over elohim. The merism first-and-last plus the explicit no-other formula closes the divine category to one.

Isa.44.8 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H1107 בלעדי, H0369 אין, H6697 צור

Force. Hayesh eloah mibaladay ve-eyn tsur bal yadati: the rhetorical question with the dedicated no-other preposition biladey, answered by the negated eyn tsur (no Rock) plus YHWH's own non-knowledge, marks the lack of any other deity as YHWH's own attested datum, not merely a confessional claim.

Isa.45.5 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3068 יהוה, H0369 אין, H5750 עוד, H2108 זולה

Force. Ani YHWH followed by eyn od (there is none else) and zulati (besides me) repeats the exclusivity twice in one verse. The bare od under the negator leaves no remainder in the divine class, ruling out additional gods of any rank.

Isa.45.21 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0369 אין, H5750 עוד, H0430 אלהים, H1107 בלעדי.

Force. Halo ani YHWH ve-eyn od elohim mibaladay: three exclusivity particles stacked in a single clause, eyn plus od plus biladey, all governing elohim. The grammatical density makes the foreclosure of additional gods explicit, not merely implied by henotheistic preference.

Isa.46.9 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0410 אל, H0369 אין, H5750 עוד, H0657 אפס.

Force. Anokhi el ve-eyn od, elohim ve-efes kamoni: the cessative noun efes (cessation, no more) parallels eyn od and rules out any comparable being. The grammar excludes both numerical multiplicity and ontological likeness, closing both addition and similarity in the divine class.

Hos.13.4 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0430 אלהים, H2108 זולה, H0369 אין.

Force. Elohim zulati lo teda u-moshia ayin bilti (and apart from me you shall know no god, and there is no Savior besides me) supplies the same particle stack outside Isaiah, in the Twelve, with zulah and ayin combined. This is the pan-canonical signal that the no-other-god grammar is not confined to one corpus.

Hos.11.9 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H0410 אל, H0376 איש, H3808 לא.

Force. Ki el anokhi velo ish (for I am God and not man) draws the creature-Creator line as a categorical opposition between el and ish under the negator lo. The grammar forecloses any trajectory in which the categories merge, that is, man becoming God or God being one of the men.

Jer.10.10 · for · genre: prophecy

Key terms. H3068 יְהוָה, H0430 אלהים, H2416 ה'.

Force. YHWH elohim emet, hu elohim chayyim u-melek olam (the LORD is the true God, he is the living God and everlasting King): emet (true) and chayyim (living) and olam (everlasting) qualify elohim with attributes the surrounding context denies to the fabricated gods of the nations, locating reality in the one and not many.

1Tim.2.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G2316 θεός, G0444 ἄνθρωπος, G3316 μεσότης.

Force. Heis gar theos, heis kai mesites theou kai anthropon, anthropos Christos Iesous: the numeral heis governs theos (one God) and then the single mesites who is anthropos. The cardinal one matches the Hebrew echad and eyn-elohim pattern, and the man-mediator clause distinguishes the human mediator from the one God rather than multiplying gods.

Jas.2.19 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1520 εἷς, G2316 θεός.

Force. Su pisteueis hoti heis estin ho theos (you believe that God is one): the predicate heis with the articular ho theos cites the Shema directly into NT idiom. James commends the bare numerical confession as orthodox even of demons, marking it as the baseline monotheistic affirmation across testaments.

Acts.17.24 · for · genre: narrative

Key terms. G2316 θεός, G4160 ποιέω, G2962 κύριος.

Force. Ho theos ho poiesas ton kosmon kai panta ta en autoi (the God who made the world and everything in it): the articular ho theos as the unique maker of the kosmos and panta places God on the Creator side of the line categorically, ruling out a divine being that itself came to be.

John.1.1 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3056 λόγος, G2316 θεός, G4314 πρός

Force. The Logos was pros ton theon and theos en ho logos: the anarthrous predicate theos predicates full deity of the Logos while the articular ton theon and the preposition pros distinguish him personally from the Father. This is one divine identity in distinct persons, not a created spiritual being ranked among others.

John.1.3 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3956 πᾶς, G1096 γίνομαι, G1223 διά

Force. Panta di autou egeneto and the emphatic oude hen (not even one thing) that came to be apart from him place the Logos as the agent through whom all things came into being. The verb ginomai (came to be) is applied to creation and explicitly not to him, marking the Logos as uncreated rather than a created elder brother.

Col.1.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2936 κτίζω, G3956 πᾶς, G1722 ἐν

Force. En autoi ektisthe ta panta, with ktizo (create) governing ta panta including thronoi, kuriotetes, archai, exousiai (thrones, dominions, rulers, authorities), and the summary di autou kai eis auton ektistai. Every created order, including the spirit ranks, is the object of his creating, which excludes him from the class of created spiritual beings.

Col.1.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4253 πρό, G3956 πᾶς, G0846 αὐτός

Force. Autos estin pro panton (he is before all things) and ta panta en autoi synesteken (in him all things hold together). The temporal pro plus the present sustaining synesteken assert priority to and continuous upholding of the whole created order, a Creator role incompatible with being one created god among many.

Heb.1.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5207 υἱός, G1080 γεννάω, G0032 ἄγγελος

Force. The rhetorical Tini gar eipen pote ton angelon (to which of the angels did he ever say) establishes that the Son-language (gegenneka, huion) is never said of any angel. This severs the Son from the angelic class outright, contradicting an elder-brother-to-angels-and-Satan placement among created spirits.

Heb.1.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4416 πρωτότοκος, G0032 ἄγγελος, G2316 θεός

Force. When the prototokos is brought into the world, proskunesatosan autoi pantes angeloi theou (let all God's angels worship him). The angels rendering worship to the firstborn place him as the object, not a peer, of angelic worship, which is owed to God alone.

Heb.1.8 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2362 θρόνος, G2316 θεός, G0165 αἰών

Force. Pros de ton huion, ho thronos sou ho theos eis ton aiona tou aionos: the Father addresses the Son as ho theos with an eternal throne. The vocative or predicate theos applied directly to the Son confirms his full deity within the one God rather than a lesser derivative divinity.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
Deut.6.4	Deut.4.35	tsk	1
1Tim.2.5	Deut.6.4	tsk	1

Isa.44.6	Isa.41.4	tsk	1
Isa.43.10	Isa.41.4	tsk	1
Isa.43.10	Isa.43.12	tsk	1
Isa.44.6	Isa.44.8	openbible	1
Isa.45.5	Isa.45.21	openbible	1
Isa.45.5	Isa.46.9	openbible	1
Isa.45.5	Hos.13.4	openbible	1
Heb.1.5	2Sam.7.14	tsk	1
Heb.1.6	Deut.32.43	tsk	1
Col.1.16	Col.1.15	tsk	1
Col.1.17	Col.1.15	tsk	1
1Tim.2.5	Jas.2.19	openbible	1

Complicating texts

Ps.82.6 · addressed

Ani amarti elohim attem (I said you are gods) is read by the immediately following verse 7 (aken ke-adam temutun, but you shall die like men) as a judicial address to human judges or rulers, a figurative use of elohim for delegated authority. It does not posit additional ontological gods and so does not unsettle the eyn-elohim pattern of Isa 44:6 and 45:5.

John.10.34 · addressed

Jesus citing Ps 82 (I said you are gods) is an a fortiori argument from the figurative elohim applied to those to whom the word of God came, not an endorsement of men becoming ontological deities. The Johannine context (theos en ho logos, John 1:1) keeps the term theos for the Son within the one divine identity, not a plurality of gods.

John.1.1 · addressed

The anarthrous predicate theos in theos en ho logos could superficially suggest a second lesser god, but Greek predicate-nominative word order before the verb (Colwell-type fronting) marks a qualitative full-deity predication, not an indefinite a god. Combined with panta di autou egeneto in verse 3, the Logos is uncreated deity within the one God, not an added divine being.

Col.1.15 · addressed

Prototokos pases ktiseos (firstborn of all creation) is glossed by the immediately following hoti clause: hoti en autoi ektisthe ta panta (because in him all things were created). The firstborn title denotes preeminence and priority over creation, not membership in it, since he is the agent of all creating. So it does not support an elder-brother-of-creatures reading.

Gen.1.26 · addressed

Na'aseh adam betsalmenu (let us make man in our image): the cohortative first-person plural with elohim has been read as a plurality-of-gods proof, but the parallel verbless clauses in Deut 6:4 and the Isa 43-46 eyn-od formulas govern the canon-level reading. The plural here does not predicate multiple gods on YHWH (he remains echad), so it does not break the no-other-god grammar.

Concordance traversed

H0259, H3068, H0430, H0410, H3335, H3808, H0369, H1107, H2108, H5750, H0376, G1520, G2316, G3056, G1096, G2936, G5207, G2362, G1080, G3316

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: n/a

The bundle reports not_in_ecm_scope true and supplies no variant_units. The anchor verses in Hebrew (Deut 6:4, Isa 43:10, 44:6,8, 45:5,21-22, 46:9, Hos 11:9, 13:4, Jer 10:10) are textually stable in the Masoretic tradition, and the Greek anchors (1Tim 2:5, Jas 2:19, Acts 17:24-25, John 1:1-3, Col 1:16-17, Heb 1:5-8) carry only minor orthographic or word-order variation in the apparatus that does not touch the monotheism or uncreated-Son claims. No CBGM data examined.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. strict_monotheism, creator_creature_distinction, plurality_of_gods_henotheism, exaltation_to_godhood

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

strict_monotheism: affirms · The Hebrew exclusivity formulas (echad, lo notsar el, eyn elohim, biladey, zulah, eyn od) read at face value assert one and only one God, directly excluding a plurality of true gods. The same grammar carries into Greek with heis theos in 1Tim 2:5 and Jas 2:19.

plurality_of_gods_henotheism: denies · A reading that treats elohim as a class admitting many true gods (with YHWH merely supreme) cannot account for the explicit negators biladey, eyn, od, and efes stacked across Isa 43-46 and Hos 13:4 that close the divine class to one. Strongest form: the plurals in Gen 1:26 and the divine council of Ps 82 indicate other elohim. Lexical answer: those plurals are not predicated as ontological peers in any verbless eyn-od construction, while the exclusivity particles are.

exaltation_to_godhood: denies · A reading on which a creature can come to be God by progression. Strongest form: Ps 82:6 calls humans elohim, and 2 Pet 1:4 speaks of becoming theias koinonoi physeos. Lexical answer: Ps 82:7 immediately qualifies them as dying like men (judicial figurative use), and the niphal lo notsar el of Isa 43:10 directly negates the very category of a god that came to be, in both temporal directions. Hos 11:9 (el anokhi velo ish) draws the same line under lo.

creator_creature_distinction: affirms · John 1:3 (panta di autou egeneto), Col 1:16-17 (en autoi ektisthe ta panta including thronoi, kuriotetes, archai, exousiai), and Heb 1:5-8 (the Son addressed as ho theos and worshipped by angels) place the Son as agent and object of creation and angelic worship rather than within the created order, so the uncreated-Son clause of the stem holds without recourse to a created elder-brother category.

lds_restorationist: denies · Strongest lexical form: theos in John 1:1 is anarthrous and could be read indefinitely (a god), Heb 1:6 has the Father bringing a firstborn into the world (compatible with a derivative deity), and Gen 1:26 plurals indicate council. Lexical answer: the predicate-nominative fronting in John 1:1 yields qualitative full deity, the prototokos title is glossed by Col 1:16 as creator-priority not creature-status, and the Isa 43-46 stack of biladey, eyn, od, efes forecloses any additional ontological god of any rank, including spirit-children.

Progressive revelation is in play: the OT Shema and Isaianic monotheism are read forward into the NT heis theos and the placement of the Son on the Creator side, with analogia scripturae linking the two testaments through the shared one-God grammar.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. How many true Gods does Scripture recognize, can a human or any being come to be God, and is the Son of God presented as uncreated Creator or as a created spiritual being ranked among angels and humanity?

The stem phrases of one substance with the Father and eternal, uncreated Son in a conciliar idiom (the homoousios formula) that is a later dogmatic taxonomy, not a lexical term in the cited texts. The underlying claims, one God, no exaltation to deity, and a Son who creates rather than is created, are directly testable on the lexical data, so the verdict is derived from the original stem while the audit notes the imported creedal vocabulary. The minority lens (exaltation, plurality) was added with its strongest lexical form to avoid strawmanning.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Deut.6.4
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H0259
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H1107
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H2108
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes	H0369
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Deut.6.4
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Isa.43.10
syntax	ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Isa.44.6
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.1.3
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Heb.1.8
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1520
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2936
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1096
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Col.1.16
interlinear	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.1.1
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Deut.6.4
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Isa.45.5
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Tim.2.5

License audit

NOT SAFE TO PUBLISH

Reason. Citations include ETCBC-BHSA (CC-BY-NC-4.0) for Hebrew clause syntax of Deut 6:4 and Isa 43-44 and MACULA-Greek (CC-BY-NC-4.0) for Greek interlinear data on John 1:1 and Col 1:16, both non-commercial and therefore not redistributable in bulk.

Source	License	Redistribute
OSHB-morphology	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESH	CC-BY-4.0	yes
ETCBC-BHSA	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no
TSK	public_domain	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

(none)